TIP For instructions on setting environment variables for your operating system, see Microsoft's "Use multiple environments in ASP.NET Core" documentation at http://mng.bz/d4OD.

For a development machine, environment variables are less useful, as all your apps would use the same values. If you set the `ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection` environment variable, for example, that variable would be added to *every* app you run locally, which sounds like more of a hassle than a benefit!

TIP To avoid collisions, you can add only environment variables that have a given prefix, such as `AddEnvironmentVariables("SomePrefix")`. The prefix is removed from the key before it's added to the `ConfigurationManager`, so the variable `SomePrefix_MyValue` is added to configuration as `MyValue`.

For development scenarios, you can use the User Secrets Manager, which effectively adds per-app environment variables, so you can have different settings for each app but store them in a different location from the app itself.

Storing secrets with the User Secrets Manager in development

The idea behind User Secrets is to simplify storing per-app secrets outside your app's project tree. This approach is similar to environment variables, but you use a unique key for each app to keep the secrets segregated.

WARNING The secrets aren't encrypted, so don't consider them to be secure. Nevertheless, it's an improvement on storing them in your project folder.

Setting up User Secrets takes a bit more effort than using environment variables, as you need to configure a tool to read and write them, add the User Secrets